

Democracy and Democratization

Section 5

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Fall 2026

Gov 20: Foundations of Comparative Politics

- 1 Paper tips
- 2 Review of concepts
- 3 Discussion: dimensions and pathways to democratization
- 4 Discussion: explanations of democratization

Reminders

- Paper due 10/7, prompts released
 - I am happy to look over an outline
 - Will not respond to paper questions within 24 hours of deadline
 - Cite (including the lectures) **with page numbers!**
- Come to office hours! Sign up:
<https://tinyurl.com/simab0H>

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- Any questions?

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- 4) Share!

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Last week: focused on describing the state and how they change over time

In this section, we look at a type of regime change, democratization's:

1. dimensions
2. pathways
3. explanations

What is democracy (according to Dahl)?

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For Dahl, democracy is about responsiveness, so (mostly) all citizens are able to

1. **Construct** their political preferences
2. **Demonstrate** their preferences to officials
3. Have a government that **accurately reflects** the distribution of these preferences

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Do you agree with him?

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- What about inclusiveness?

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- Liberalization happens when $\text{cost}_{\text{toleration}} < \text{costs}_{\text{repression}} \rightarrow$ competitive regimes
- What about inclusiveness? Revolution? What would Berman, Moore, Varshney, Rustow say?

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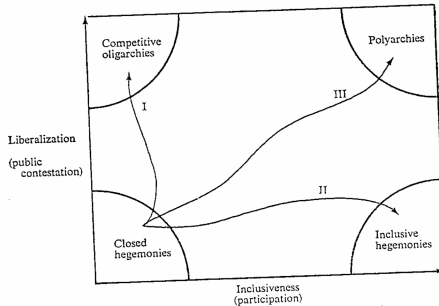


FIGURE 1.2 Liberalization, Inclusiveness, and Democratization

What path did the US take?

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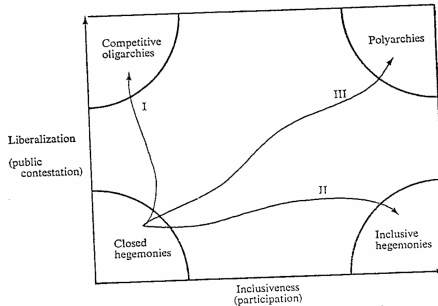


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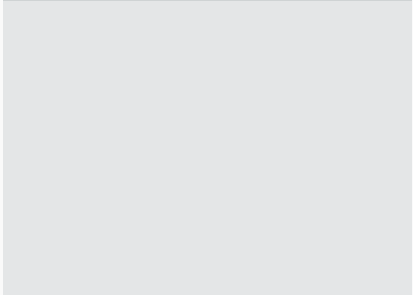
What path did the US take? What about some of the cases Professor Levitsky mentioned in Thursday's class?

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Where would you place Berman (2007)?

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Which do you find more convincing? Which theory explains the most number of cases?

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Next week: reminders

Reminder: start the paper this weekend!

Focus on these readings: Huntington , Levitsky and Way ,
Gunitsky , Levitsky and Ziblatt , Svolik

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- Section website: <https://tinyurl.com/gov20sb26>